



ChrisTV PVR Professional Get complete control over your TV-Tuner!

ChrisTV PVR Professional is a personal video recorder that can record from TV tuners, as well as any video capture source connected to the PC—such as a DV Camcorder.

Installation is fairly easy, and you're automatically taken to the configuration tool that detects and configures your TV Tuner's audio and video and starts a channel detection routine. It detects channels with no trouble, and you can add channels if any are missed. The skinnable interface is slick and the controls are very easy to use. Video can be viewed in two modes: commonly used overlay, or the newer and better VMR9. You can watch a 5 x 5 channel preview grid, and there is a zoom function too.

ChrisTV can be used with both internal and

external USB TV tuners and you can use up to four of them simultaneously. You can record in MPEG1 / 2, as well as AVI with compression. You can use preset recording profiles or even save custom recording profiles for use later. Time-shift and scheduling is present, and you can use these in conjunction with a third party Electronic Program Guide. You can use image processing filters to add effects.

One of the major plus points of ChrisTV is that it supports a large number of TV tuner remotes—something most other PVR

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



software miss. There is also support for TV tuners with on-board audio chips. ChrisTV does have one negative—no codecs are provided with the package and you need to purchase them separately from third party manufacturers to use them while capturing video. ChrisTV PVR Professional is priced just right at \$ 59.95

(Rs 2400), but if you can do without recording in VIVO graphics cards and other video capture devices, then you can get ChrisTV PVR Standard for \$ 44.95 (Rs 1800).

Contact: Chris P.C. srl
E-mail: contact@chris-tv.com
Web site: www.chris-tv.com
Price: Rs \$ 59.95 (Rs 2,400)

Logitech MX Air Cord-free, surface-free control

Revolutionary products are hard to come by, and the Logitech MX Air is one we've been eyeing since its release. The MX Air works something like the Nintendo Wii's innovative Wiimote.

The MX Air is unlike any other mouse. It's a handheld controller that you can wave about to move the pointer on the screen. It's definitely attractive with its sleek streamlined shape. It's also very light and sports a glossy black finish with a chrome metallic surface on the back. The shape of the mouse has been designed with comfort in mind—but it does get slippery after long hours of use with sweaty palms.

There are two mouse buttons, but no middle click button, though you can assign the function to one of the other buttons using the bundled SetPoint software. There's a touch panel between the main mouse buttons, and you can run your fingers on the panel to scroll.

It has to be said the mouse is really difficult to get started with, but over time it becomes more usable. For those who can't use it, there's also a laser

RATINGS	
Feature	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

sensor under the mouse so you can use the same device on your desk like a regular wireless mouse. The drivers allow you to set separate sensitivity settings for the mouse when on the desk and when off it. The mouse is very accurate, and any inaccuracy you might experience is more likely because of the human hand not being steady enough.

Playing FPS games on it is very difficult and close to impossible in air (we just thought we'd try), but it's a decent mouse on the desk. It makes a lot of sense as a controller for a Media Center PC and it also makes a good presentation tool. It's a good product that does its job well, but



Rs 8,995 seems like a lot to pay for the novelty.

Specifications
Capacity: 512 MB Flash memory, SD expandable slot; Music formats: AAC, MP3, WAV; Dual 3.5 mm audio jacks; Lanyard with aluminium ring

Contact: Rashi Peripherals Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-67090909
E-mail: Logitech@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.logitech.com
Price: Rs 8,995

ViewSonic VX2835WM TV Replacement?

ViewSonic has delivered a gargantuan monitor in a size we've never seen before—28 whole inches. The resolution is the same as a 23 or 24 inch LCD—1920 x 1200 pixels—which equates to proper HD resolution, as 1080p can be natively displayed.

The monitor itself is huge, and the enclosure thick—thicker than what we've seen for TN panels. We were surprised at the light weight though—the BenQ FP 241C (S-PVA panel based) weighs more. There's no swivel or height adjustment on the ViewSonic—a sure sign of its value orientation.

It's geared towards being a proper entertainment system accompaniment with

Composite, S-Video, Component and HDMI connects. What shocked us was the lack of PC connectivity options—one measly D-Sub and no DVI—inexcusable!

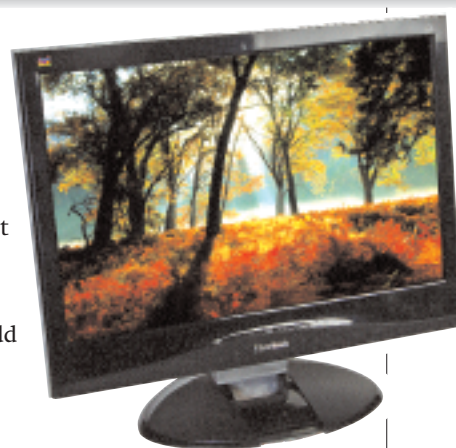
During our DisplayMate colour test, we noticed a few problems with colour purity—typically TN, this.

Our test DVD was nirvana on such a large screen, but at times, dark edges of leaves blend with the shadows—this is a common with all monitors, and if you're looking for it, the effect is quite noticeable.

While playing games like F.E.A.R. and Oblivion, we noticed the issue with contrast again—especially with the former, which is a

dark and atmospheric game. Oblivion—a much brighter game with lots of foliage and outdoor scenes—looked gorgeous.

The VX2835 is also not the entertainment screen we hoped it'd be. That's not to say it was bad, but we recommend you buy a 24-inch monitor based on a true 8-bit panel to really add sparkle to your visual experience. This is only for you if you really need the extra inches—like surfing with your wireless combo kit from the comfort of your bed with your monitor a good few feet away.



Specifications
Display Area—28-inches, Resolution—1920 x 1200 pixels, Contrast Ratio—800:1, Brightness—500 cd/m2, Weight—12 kgs

Contact: Roop Technology Pvt Ltd
Phone: 91-22-26681921
E-mail: umang@rooponline.com
Web site: in.viewsonic.com
Price: Rs 45,000

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

CyberLink PowerDVD 7.3 Ultra And the PC became a theatre!

CyberLink's new PowerDVD 7.3 Ultra is a software disc player with all the controls and features that you may find in any hardware player, and much more.

The interface is very clean and easy to understand. The controls are at the bottom of the window and balloon help is always there, so you'll never be left confused. You can even control the speed of playback, and it doesn't cause the "Chip'n'Dale" effect on voice even at high playback speeds. There are many hotkeys available during playback, so you can exercise total control with a flick of a button.

PowerDVD is not resource hungry—on our modest computer, it starts up in a second and plays HD clips with complete ease. It supports native hardware acceleration provided by

most modern graphics chipsets and takes advantage of it to take the load off the CPU while rendering HD video. Playback is stutterless and audio was crisp and clear thanks to the smart de-interlacing support. CLEV-2 is a proprietary video enhancement technology from CyberLink that detects video content and dynamically adjusts brightness / contrast / saturation ratios for a better viewing experience. CyberLink Pano Vision is a non-linear video stretching technology that is used to stretch the video to your desktop resolution with minimal distortion. All speaker configurations are supported, and there are a host of different audio modes, such as Dolby Headphone that creates a virtual surround sound experience while using headphones, Dolby Virtual



Speaker that creates virtual surround sound through two speakers, etc. Some of the newer sound technologies supported are Dolby Pro Logic Iix, Neo:6, and SRS TruSurroundXT.

DivX, DVD (MPEG-2), DVD+VR, DVD-VR, DVD-Audio, VCD (MPEG-1), SVCD,

RATINGS	
Feature	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

MiniDVD formats and DVD files on hard drive are all supported. For HD aficionados, PowerDVD also supports Blu-ray as well as HD DVD with support for the H.264 format. There is also a See-It-All option that will adjust the playback speed of your movie so that you can watch an entire movie before your laptop battery runs out. This software is a worthy buy.

Contact: CyberLink Corp
Web site: www.cyberlink.com
Price: US\$ 99.99